

Chapter 4 – Metasploit Framework

Part 2 – msfconsole Basics

What is msfconsole?

The primary interface for Metasploit. It is used to search modules, configure options, manage sessions, and perform authorized penetration testing tasks.

Core Commands

msfconsole – Start Metasploit.
version – Show framework version.
help or ? – Display help.
clear – Clear the screen.
exit or quit – Exit the console.

Module Commands

search – Search for modules.
info <module> – View module details.
use <module> – Load a module.
back – Return to the main prompt.

Viewing Information

show options – Display configurable parameters.
show payloads – List compatible payloads.
show targets – Display supported targets.

Useful Features

Tab completion speeds up typing. Arrow keys recall previous commands. Help is available for individual commands using help command_name.

Workflow

Start msfconsole → Search module → Read info → Use module → Show options → Choose payload (if applicable) → Configure → Run only in authorized environments.

Beginner Mistakes

Skipping the info command, forgetting required options, loading the wrong module, or assuming every search result is appropriate.

Quick Revision

Always review module information before use. Search first, load second, configure third, execute only with proper authorization.